

## DAILY PRACTICE PAPER- 15/05/2026

**Q1.** Which of the following statements regarding the 42nd Constitutional Amendment Act of 1976 is/are correct?

1. It added the words 'Socialist', 'Secular', and 'Integrity' to the Preamble.
2. It transferred five subjects from the State List to the Concurrent List.
3. It made the President bound by the advice of the cabinet.

*Options:*

- A) 1 and 2 only
- B) 2 and 3 only
- C) 1 and 3 only
- D) 1, 2, and 3

**Correct Answer:**

- D) 1, 2, and 3

**Explanation:** The 42nd Amendment, often called the 'Mini-Constitution', introduced all three of these major changes. It amended the Preamble, moved subjects like Education and Forests to the Concurrent List, and amended Article 74 to make the President bound by the cabinet's advice.

**Q2.** In the administrative terminology of the Mauryan Empire, what did the term 'Sita' refer to?

- A) A religious tax collected during festivals
- B) Revenue generated from crown lands
- C) A specialized silver currency
- D) The elite royal bodyguard

**Correct Answer:** B) Revenue generated from crown lands

**Explanation:** In Mauryan administration, 'Sita' referred specifically to the income and agricultural produce generated directly from state-owned crown lands. This revenue was overseen by an official known as the *Sitadhyaksha*.

**Q3.** Arrange the following tributaries of the Indus River from North to South:

1. Chenab
2. Jhelum
3. Ravi
4. Sutlej

*Options:*

- A) 1-2-3-4
- B) 2-1-3-4
- C) 2-3-1-4
- D) 1-3-2-4

**Correct Answer:** B) 2-1-3-4 **Explanation:**

Looking at the geographical sequence from North to South, the correct order of these left-bank tributaries of the Indus is Jhelum, Chenab, Ravi, and Sutlej.

**Q4.** Which of the following monetary policy actions by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) is most likely to lead to an expansion of credit in the economy?

- A) Increasing the Cash Reserve Ratio (CRR)
- B) Buying government securities in the open market
- C) Increasing the Statutory Liquidity Ratio (SLR)
- D) Raising the Repo Rate

**Correct Answer:** B) Buying government securities in the open market

**Explanation:** Under Open Market Operations (OMO), when the RBI buys securities, it injects liquid money into the banking system. This increases the reserves of commercial banks, enabling them to extend more loans and expand credit. The other options all restrict credit.

**Q5.** The twinkling of stars in the night sky is an optical phenomenon primarily caused by:

- A) Atmospheric reflection
- B) Atmospheric refraction

C) Total internal reflection

D) Dispersion of light

**Correct Answer:** B) Atmospheric refraction

**Explanation:** As starlight travels through Earth's atmosphere, it undergoes continuous refraction (bending) due to changing air densities and temperatures. This causes the apparent position and brightness of the star to fluctuate rapidly, which we perceive as twinkling.

**Q6.** Pernicious anaemia is a condition caused by the deficiency of which of the following vitamins?

- A) Vitamin B1
- B) Vitamin B6
- C) Vitamin B12
- D) Vitamin C

**Correct Answer:** C) Vitamin B12

**Explanation:** Pernicious anaemia is a specific type of macrocytic anaemia that occurs when the body cannot absorb enough Vitamin B12 (Cyanocobalamin) from the gastrointestinal tract. Vitamin B12 is essential for healthy red blood cell production and nerve function.

**Q7.** The 'August Offer' of 1940, which proposed to recognize the Indians' right to

frame their own constitution, was issued by which Viceroy?

- A) Lord Linlithgow
- B) Lord Mountbatten
- C) Lord Wavell
- D) Lord Irwin

**Correct Answer:** A) Lord Linlithgow

**Explanation:** Lord Linlithgow made the August Offer in 1940 to secure Indian political cooperation during World War II. It was the first time the British explicitly promised that framing a new constitution would primarily be the responsibility of Indians, alongside the promise of dominion status.

**Q8.** Which Article of the Indian Constitution implicitly safeguards an individual's right to marry a person of their choice?

- A) Article 19
- B) Article 21
- C) Article 25
- D) Article 29

**Correct Answer:** B) Article 21

**Explanation:** The Supreme Court of India has ruled in several landmark judgments (such as the Hadiya case) that the right to marry a person of one's choice is an integral facet of the Right to Life and

Personal Liberty guaranteed under Article 21 of the Constitution.

**Q9.** In the context of physical geography, which of the following ocean currents is classified as a cold current?

- A) Gulf Stream
- B) Agulhas Current
- C) Kuroshio Current
- D) Benguela Current

**Correct Answer:** D) Benguela Current

**Explanation:** The Benguela Current is a cold, broad ocean current that flows northward along the western coast of southern Africa. The Gulf Stream, Agulhas, and Kuroshio are all warm currents.

**Q10.** The economic principle 'Gresham's Law' is primarily related to which of the following concepts?

- A) Supply and demand of luxury goods
- B) Circulation of currency
- C) Progressive taxation policies
- D) Diminishing marginal utility

**Correct Answer:** B) Circulation of currency

**Explanation:** Gresham's Law is a monetary principle stating that "bad money drives out good." If there are two

forms of commodity money in circulation, which are accepted by law as having similar face value, the more valuable commodity will gradually disappear from circulation as people hoard it, leaving only the less valuable "bad" money in circulation.

ASHOKA IAS ACADEMY